תַּקָּנַת הַשָּׁבִין

Takanas HaShavin

An Interlinear Translation
with Annotated Source Footnotes

Rabbi Tzadok HaKohen Rabinowitz of Lublin
(1823–1900)

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VOLUME II

כֶּרֶךְ ב · סִימָנִים יא–טו

Simanim 11–15

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Takanas HaShavin

Volume II · Simanim 11–15

This volume presents Simanim 11–15 of Takanas HaShavin, Rabbi Tzadok HaKohen's work on teshuvah, with Hebrew–English interlinear translation and annotated source notes.

The Hebrew and English are presented in close, phrase-by-phrase sequence. Hebrew appears in regular type, English translation in bold, and contextual source footnotes in smaller regular type.

Volume I contains the Introduction and Simanim 1–10. This volume contains Simanim 11–15. Edition differences and sources known through Rav Tzadok's citation are identified in the notes.

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Siman 11

סִימָן יא

Teshuvah from fear and the path to love

תשובה מיראה והעלייה לאהבה

Se’if 1 · סעיף א

The theme: Teshuvah from fear heals only “from here onward” and, reaching back, recasts willful sins (zedonos) as inadvertent ones (shegagos). Yet it leaves the penitent “like a healed baal mum, a trace of whose name remains” (Rashi). Complete healing — turning the sin itself into nedavah and merit — belongs to teshuvah from love, which the verse sets after the return from fear.

(א) הַשֵּׁנִי — **The second:** תְּשׁוּבָה מִיִּרְאָה — **repentance out of fear,** מְרַפֵּא מִכָּאן וּלְהַבָּא — **heals from now onward,** אֲבָל עַל הַקּוֹדֶם — **but for what came before,**

אֵין מְתֻקָּן לְגַמְרֵי — **it is not fully repaired,** רַק כְּבַעַל מוּם — **only like one with a blemish** שֶׁנִּתְרַפֵּא — **who was healed,** שֶׁמִּקְצָת שְׁמוֹ עָלָיו — **whose name partly remains on him;**

כֵּן הוּא בְּרַשִׁ״י — **so it is in Rashi,** וּכְתִיב “דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל” — **in the entry beginning “and it is written”;** (רֵישׁ עַמּוּד ב) וּבַגְּמָרָא — **and in the Gemara (beginning of side b)** דְּמוֹעִיל עַל הַקּוֹדֶם גַּם כֵּן — **that it also avails for what came before.**

וְלוּלֵי דִּבְרֵי רַשִׁ״י — **And were it not for Rashi’s words,** הָיָה נִרְאֶה לְפָרֵשׁ אִיפְכָּא — **it would seem to explain the reverse,** לְשׁוֹנָבִים[1] — **that “wayward ones”**

דְּמַעִיקָּרָא שׁוֹנָבִים — **at first, “wayward ones,”** זֶהוּ מִיִּרְאָה — **this is out of fear,** שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה כִּשְׁגָגוֹת — **which is made like inadvertent sins,** וְעַל יְדֵי שׁוֹנָבוּת — **and through waywardness.**

הַיְנוּ כִּשְׁוֹגֵג — **meaning as inadvertent.** וְאֶרְפָּא — **And “I will heal,”** דְּסֵיֵם “אֹהֲבֵם נְדָבָה — **which ends “I will love them freely,”,** הַיְנוּ מֵאַהֲבָה — **means out of love,**

וּרְפוּאָה דְּמְשׁוּבָתָם — **and the healing of “their backsliding”** הַיְנוּ שֶׁלֹּא יִהְיֶה — **means that he will not be,** כְּמוֹ שׁוֹנָב גַּם כֵּן — **like one wayward either,** רַק שֶׁמֵּאַהֲבָתָם — **but that out of their love**

יַחְשִׁיב הָעוֹן — **He will count the sin.** לִנְדָבָה וּלְמִצְוָה וּזְכִיּוֹת — **as a freewill offering, a mitzvah, and merits.** וְאַף עַל פִּי — **And although** שֶׁאֵין הַסֵּדֶר כָּאן וְכוּלֵי — **the order here, etc.**

מְכֻוָּן לְסֵדֶר הַכְּתוּבִים — **is not aligned with the order of the verses,** שֶׁסִּדֵּר תְּחִלָּה בְּקֻשְׁיָא — **which he first arranged in the question,** יֵשׁ לוֹמַר — **one can say.** דְּבָמָה דְּסֵיֵם פָּתַח — **that with what he ended, he began.**

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1 Rashi on Yoma 86a, s.v. “וכתיב ארפא”, writes: “משמע מכאן ואילך כבעל מום שנתרפא שמקצת שמו עליו” — “This implies healing from now onward, like a person cured of a blemish who still bears something of its former designation.” In the following gloss, “כאן מאהבה”, Rashi explains that return from love uproots the sin from its beginning. Rav Tzadok first states Rashi’s distinction and then considers reversing the reading of the verses. This note distinguishes his proposed interpretation from Rashi’s actual words; Yoma 86b separately distinguishes deliberate sins becoming inadvertent through fear from their transformation into merits through love. **Sources:** Rashi on Yoma 86a, s.v. וכתיב אֵרְפָּא and כאן מאהבה; Yoma 86a–b; Hoshea 14:5; Yirmeyahu 3:22.

וְגַם יֵשׁ לוֹמַר — **And one can also say** דְּהַכְתּוּבִים נָקַט — **that he took the verses,** כְּסִדְרָן בִּנְבִיאִים וּכְתוּבִים — **in their order in Prophets and Writings,** וּתְרֵי עָשָׂר מְאֻחָר — **and the Twelve (Minor Prophets) come later**

כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ — **as they said (** בָּבָא בַּתְרָא יד עמוד ב),[2] — **(Bava Batra 14b),** וּבְתֵרוּץ הִקְדִּים — **and in the answer he put first** מֵאַהֲבָה — **"out of love,".**

שֶׁהִיא הַמְּעֻלָּה — **which is the superior one.** וְזֶהוּ כְּפִי הַגִּרְסָא — **And this is according to the version** שֶׁבְּעֵין יַעֲקֹב — **in Ein Yaakov (** שֶׁלְּפָנַי דְּפוּס פִּירְדָא) — **in the copy before me, the Fürth printing**

שָׁם (סִימָן עַ״ג) — **there (section 73) "** וּכְתִיב אֶרְפָּא מְשׁוּבָתָם", — **"and it is written, 'I will heal their backsliding,'"** וְכֵן הוּא בְּרַשִׁ״י — **and so it is in Rashi** שָׁם שֶׁבְּעֵין יַעֲקֹב — **in Ein Yaakov there,**

וְכֵן בְּיִלְקוּט — **and so in Yalkut (** יִרְמְיָה סוֹף סִימָן רס״ט) — **(Jeremiah, end of section 269)** וְהַיְנוּ קְרָא דְּהוֹשֵׁעַ.[3] — **and that is the verse in Hosea.** וּלְפִי גִּרְסָא זוֹ — **And according to this version**

נִרְאֶה וַדַּאי הַפֵּירוּשׁ — **the explanation certainly appears** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַבְתִּי — **as I wrote,** מִדִּכְתִיב "אֹהֲבֵם", — **since it is written "I will love them,"** וְגַם מִדְּלָא מַקְשֶׁה — **and also since he does not ask**

מִסִּיּוּם לְשׁוֹן הַכָּתוּב — **from the end of the verse's wording** דְּיִרְמְיָה עַצְמוֹ — **of Jeremiah itself,** אֶלָּא דְּמַיְיתֵי הָאי — **but rather brings this one** מִשּׁוּם הַתֵּרוּץ — **because of the answer**

דְּבֵיהּ מְפֹרָשׁ אַחַר כָּךְ "אֹהֲבֵם". — **in which "I will love them" is afterward stated explicitly.** וְגַם יֵשׁ לוֹמַר — **And one can also say** דְּעִקַּר הַקַּשְׁיָא מֵהָא — **that the main question is from this,** דִּכְתִיב "מִדִּכְתִיב "אֹהֲבֵם נְדָבָה" — **since it is written "I will love them freely,"**

מַשְׁמַע — **implying,** דְּאֵינָם כְּשׁוֹבָבִים גַּם כֵּן — **that they are not like wayward ones either,** רַק נֶחְשָׁב עוֹד לִנְדָבָה — **but are further counted as freewill,** וְעַל כֵּן "אֹהֲבֵם" — **and therefore "I will love them",**

וְכמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַבְתִּי — **as I wrote;** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן — **which is not so** קְרָא דְּיִרְמְיָה — **for the verse in Jeremiah,** דְּחַד קְרָא הוּא — **which is a single verse**

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2 **Bava Basra 14b** — order of Nevi'im: the baraisa lists Yirmiyah, Yechezkel, Yeshayah and then Trei Asar. It asks why Hoshea, who prophesied earlier, was not placed first, and answers that his short book was joined to the single scroll of the Twelve; if written separately it might be lost. Rashi notes that Chaggai, Zecharyah and Malachi were the last prophets, so Hoshea is counted with their collected scroll. R' Tzadok therefore distinguishes historical chronology from canonical book-order: the Gemara's question can cite Yirmiyah before Hoshea because that is their order in the received sequence, while its answer gives priority to love because love is the higher spiritual rung.

3 Rav Tzadok reports that the Fürth Ein Yaakov before him read 'וכתיב ארפא משובתם'—the phrasing of Hoshea 14:5—rather than the received Bavli wording 'ארפא משובותיכם' from Yirmeyahu 3:22. This is a reported printed-text variant, not something we may silently impose upon the Gemara. Crucial qualification: the currently accessible Yalkut Shimoni on Yirmeyahu, remez 269, actually introduces the teaching with 'שובו בנים שובבים' and quotes 'ארפא' under that Yirmeyahu passage; it does not independently establish the Hoshea reading. Rav Tzadok himself discovers and explains that very difficulty in Se'if 2. The Fürth Ein Yaakov typography and its Rif commentary still require direct facsimile collation. The conceptual distinction he develops is his proposed interpretation, not the unopposed received text. **Sources:** Hoshea 14:5; Yirmeyahu 3:22; Yoma 86a; Yalkut Shimoni on Nach, remez 269; Takanas HaShavin 11, Seif 1–2; Ein Yaakov, Fürth imprint (original variant requires facsimile collation).

לֹא מַפְסִיקִיהּ לֵיהּ. — **that he does not split.** וְגַם סֵיפֵיהּ — **And also the end of it,** דְּ"אֶרְפָּא מְשׁוּבוֹתֵיכֶם" — **"I will heal your backslidings,"** קָאֵי אַמִּירְאָה — **refers to fear,**

וְאֵין רְפוּאָה גְּמוּרָה — **and there is no complete healing,** רַק מִקְצַת שְׁמוֹ עָלָיו — **only his name partly remains on him,** מַה שְּׁאֵין כֵּן — **which is not so** רְפוּאַת הוֹשֵׁעַ — **for the healing in Hosea.**

הוּא לְגַמְרֵי[4] — **which is complete.** וְנִרְאֶה סִיּוּעַ — **And support appears** לְמַה שֶּׁכָּתַבְתִּי — **for what I wrote** מִמֵּימְרָא הַקּוֹדֶמֶת שָׁם — **from the preceding statement there**

דְּמַבִיאָה רְפוּאָה — **that brings healing** מִקְּרָא דְּ"אֶרְפָּא" וְגוֹמֵר — **from the verse "I will heal," etc. ",** נְדָבָה", עַיֵּין שָׁם — **"freely," see there,** וְאַמַּאי לָא מַיְיתֵי — **and why does it not bring**

קְרָא דְּ"אֶרְפָּא מְשׁוּבוֹתֵיכֶם" — **the verse "I will heal your backslidings"?** דִּירְמְיָה דְּקַדִּים — **of Jeremiah, which comes first?** אֲבָל לְמַה שֶּׁכָּתַבְתִּי נִיחָא — **But according to what I wrote it is fine,** דְּהָתָם שָׁבָא לְבָאֵר — **for there, where he comes to explain**

גְּדֻלַּת הַתְּשׁוּבָה — **the greatness of repentance,** נָקַט הָאִי קְרָא — **he took this verse** דְּתְשׁוּבָה מֵאַהֲבָה הַגְּדוֹלָה — **of repentance out of love, the greater.** שֶׁמְּרַפֵּאת הַקּוֹדֶם לְגַמְרֵי[5] — **which heals the earlier completely.**

וְעַיֵּין בַּחִדּוּשֵׁי הָרִי"ף — **And see the novellae of the Rif** שֶׁבְּעֵין יַעֲקֹב שָׁם — **in Ein Yaakov there,** דִּקְדֵּק בָּאֱמֶת — **who indeed scrutinized** לְפֵירוּשׁ רַשִׁ"י — **according to Rashi's explanation**

לָמָּה נָקַט הָתָם — **why there he took** מִמַּעֲלַת הַתְּשׁוּבָה מִיִּרְאָה — **the merit of repentance out of fear,** דְּאֵינָהּ כָּל כָּךְ גְּדוֹלָה — **which is not so great,** עַיֵּין שָׁם — **see there.**

וּלְמַה שֶּׁכָּתַבְתִּי נִיחָא[6] — **and according to what I wrote it is fine.**

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4 **Peri Tzadik, Vayeilech and Shabbat Shuvah 9**: וההבדל בין שוגג למזיד שהמזיד הוא עם מחשבה ורצון וזה נתבטל ע"י הדיבור ונשאר רק המעשה לבד ולכן נעשית לו כשגגות. — "The difference between an inadvertent sinner and an intentional sinner is that the intentional act is accompanied by thought and desire; this is nullified through speech, and only the act remains, so it becomes like inadvertent sins." This directly explains why fear leaves a residue requiring fuller healing. The parallel is an explanation of Rav Tzadok's distinction, not a quotation from RoshHashanah8.

5 **Yoma 86a** and **Hoshea 14:2**-5: "Great is teshuvah, for it brings healing to the world," derived from "I will heal their backsliding; I will love them freely." The prophetic context moves from Israel's command, "Return, O Israel," and its verbal confession (vv. 2-4), to Hashem's answer of healing and renewed love (v. 5). Mefarshei Tanakh: Radak explains that Hashem heals the rebellion committed until now and then loves Israel with a freely given love once His anger has turned away. Metzudas David sharpens the distinction: confession can remove enmity, but it cannot by itself produce love; the renewed love is a divine gift even when Israel is not yet worthy. Malbim likewise reads a sequence — first the wound of backsliding is healed, and afterward Hashem returns not merely to pardon but to love. R' Tzadok's distinctive move: he reads *ohavem nedavah* not only as undeserved divine love but as the sign that the past itself has been transvalued: the avon becomes a *nedavah*, mitzvah and merit. In *Peri Tzadik, Vayeilech and Shabbos Shuvah §§9 and 11*, he repeats the same order — human return, divine assistance toward complete love, and finally the former bad deeds yielding a pleasing fragrance. That parallel shows why this verse, rather than Yirmiyah's more limited "healing," bears the se'if's idea of total retroactive repair.

6 'Chiddushei HaRif' here denotes the aggadic commentator R. Yoshiyahu Pinto, author of Me'or Einayim on Ein Yaakov, not R. Yitzchak Alfasi. Rav Tzadok reports that the Rif challenges Rashi's association of the expression 'ארפא' with the lesser return from fear, because Hoshea also says 'אוהבם נדבה,' indicating love. The contrast illuminates Rav Tzadok's proposed reconciliation: Yirmeyahu's healing can leave the prior offense as inadvertence, whereas the healing in Hoshea encompasses return from love. This description follows Rav Tzadok's direct report and the accessible biblical and Talmudic wording; the exact original Rif gloss and the Fürth Ein Yaakov witness have NOT been collated page-for-page and should not be presented as independently certified. **Sources:** Takanas HaShavin 11, Seif 1–2; Rashi on Yoma 86a; Hoshea 14:5;

Se’if 2 · סעיף ב

The theme: In the Yalkut the proof-verse of the earlier statement really is the Yirmiyah verse, and there it cannot be emended. So the Rif’s difficulty (why “I will heal” — from fear — is paired with “loving them freely” — from love) actually confirms R’ Tzadok’s reading. The order of the verse mirrors the order of the penitent’s ascent: first “Return” — from fear, which depends on man’s own effort, “for all is in the hands of Heaven except the fear of Heaven”; then “I will heal” — from love, which Heaven grants him.

(ב) אַךְ רָאִיתִי בְּיַלְקוּט (ירמיה שָׁם) — **But I saw in Yalkut ((Jeremiah, there)** הַגִּרְסָא בֶּאֱמֶת — **that the version, indeed,** בַּמֵּימְרָא הַקּוֹדֶמֶת — **in the preceding statement**

מִקְרָא דְּ"שׁוּבוּ" וְגוֹמֵר — **is from the verse “Return,” etc. “,** אֶרְפָּא מְשׁוּבוֹתֵיכֶם" דִּירְמְיָה — **“I will heal your backslidings” of Jeremiah,** וְשָׁם אִי אֶפְשָׁר לְהַגִּיהַּ, — **and there it is impossible to emend,** מִדְּמַיְיתֵי לֵיהּ — **since he brings it**

לְהָהוּא מֵימְרָא שָׁם בִּירְמְיָה — **for that statement there, in Jeremiah,** אַמִּקְרָא זֶה — **on this verse** וְלֹא בְּהוֹשֵׁעַ, — **and not in Hosea;** עַל כָּרְחָךְ — **you must say**

דְּכָךְ הָיְתָה הַנָּסְחָא — **that so was the text** לִפְנֵי הַמְחַבֵּר — **before the author.** בַּגְּמָרָא שָׁם — **in the Gemara there.** וְנוּסַח הַגְּמָרָא הוּא — **And the Gemara’s text is**

גַּם בְּהָךְ רוּמְיָא גַּם כֵּן — **also in this contradiction as well: “** וּכְתִיב אֶרְפָּא מְשׁוּבוֹתֵיכֶם" — **“and it is written, ‘I will heal your backslidings,’”** וְהַיְנוּ סֵיפָא — **and that is the end.** דְּאוֹתוֹ מִקְרָא דִּירְמְיָה — **of that verse of Jeremiah.**

וְכֵן הוּא בְּהָרִי"ף — **And so it is in the Rif,** בְּעֵין יַעֲקֹב — **in Ein Yaakov,** וְהוּא הִקְשָׁה — **and he asked** אֹהֲבֵם נְדָבָה" מִקְרָא דְּ"— **from the verse “I will love them freely,”**

דְּמַשְׁמַע מֵאַהֲבָה — **which implies out of love,** כֵּן גַּם וּכְתִיב "אֶרְפָּא — **and “I will heal” is also written,** וְהַיְנוּ לְפֵירוּשׁ רַשִׁ"י — **that is, according to Rashi’s explanation.** וְנִדְחָק[7] — **and he is forced into a strained reading.**

אֲבָל גַּם זֶה מוֹכִיחַ — **But this too proves,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַבְתִּי — **as I wrote,** דְּהַקְשָׁיָא דְּ"אֶרְפָּא מְשׁוּבוֹתֵיכֶם" — **that the question from “I will heal your backslidings”,** מַשְׁמַע דְּמַרְפֵּא גַּם הַשְׁוּבָת — **implies it heals waywardness too.**

וְזֶהוּ מֵאַהֲבָה — **and this is out of love.** וְסֵדֶר הַכְּתוּבִים — **And the order of the verses** הוּא כְּפִי סֵדֶר הַמַּדְרֵגוֹת — **is according to the order of the levels,** לְאָדָם הַשָּׁב — **of a person who returns,**

Yirmeyahu 3:22; R. Yoshiyahu Pinto, Me’or Einayim / Chiddushei HaRif on Ein Yaakov (exact printed gloss pending collation).

7 Yalkut Shimoni, the Rif on Ein Yaakov, and R’ Tzadok’s framework: *Yalkut Shimoni* is a medieval anthology arranged along the verses of Tanakh. In Yirmiyah, remez 269, it places the teaching upon “Return, wayward children; I will heal your backslidings” (**Yirmiyah 3:22**). Because the material is attached to that verse rather than to Hoshea, its location is textual evidence that the compiler’s Gemara read the Yirmiyah wording; R’ Tzadok therefore reopens and qualifies the variant discussed in the previous se’if. The “Rif” here is R’ Yoshiyahu Pinto’s aggadic commentary *Me’or Einayim* on Ein Yaakov, not R’ Yitzchak Alfasi. His difficulty is that Rashi associates “I will heal” with the lesser teshuvah from fear, while “I will love them freely” plainly denotes love. R’ Tzadok turns that strain into a sequence: the human call “Return” begins in fear, and the divine “I will heal” culminates in love. Compare ***Machshavos Charutz §7***, where he describes lower and upper teshuvah as the two heh’s of the Divine Name. The lower return prepares the vessel; the upper return completes the healing. Se’if Beis thus joins textual criticism to R’ Tzadok’s recurring two-stage map of teshuvah.

דְּתְחִלָּה הוּא מִיִּרְאָה — **for first it is from fear.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ בָּא לְמַאֲהָבָה — **and afterward he comes to love.** וּמִיִּרְאָה אָמַר "שׁוּבוּ", — **And regarding fear He said "Return,",** תְּלָה בְּהִשְׁתַּדְּלוּת אָדָם — **relying on human effort,**

דְּהַכֹּל בִּידֵי שָׁמַיִם — **for everything is in Heaven's hands** חוּץ מִיִּרְאַת שָׁמַיִם — **except fear of Heaven,** (בִּבְרָכוֹת ל״ג סוֹף עַמּוּד ב׳) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ — **as they said (Berachos 33b, end)**

מִקְרָא ד"כִּי אִם לְיִרְאָה". — **from the verse "but only to fear."** "וְאַחַר כָּךְ אֶרְפָּא" — **And afterward "I will heal"** תְּלָה בְּהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, — **He attributed to the Blessed Name,** כִּי מַה שֶּׁזּוֹכֶה אַחַר כָּךְ — **for what one afterward merits**

לִתְשׁוּבָה מֵאַהֲבָה — **of repentance out of love** הוּא מַה שֶּׁמִּן הַשָּׁמַיִם מְסַיְּעִין אוֹתוֹ.[8] — **is what Heaven helps him with.** וְכַיָּדוּעַ הַטַּעַם — **And as the reason is known,** דִּלְאַהֲבָה אֵין צָרִיךְ — **that for love there is no need for**

הִשְׁתַּדְּלוּת אָדָם כָּל כָּךְ, — **so much human effort,** רַק בָּאָה מֵאֵלָיו — **but it comes of itself** אַחַר הַיִּרְאָה — **after fear,** שֶׁהִיא נוּקְבָא — — **which is feminine — "**

אִשָּׁה יִרְאַת ה'", — **"a woman who fears the Lord,",** וְאַהֲבָה בְּרָזָא דִּדְכוּרָא — **and love is in the secret of the masculine.** וְדֶרֶךְ אִישׁ לַחֲזוֹר וְכוּ'[9] — **and it is the way of a man to go seeking (a wife), etc.** וְכָךְ בְּהוֹשֵׁעַ — **And so in Hosea**

פָּתַח "שׁוּבָה יִשְׂרָאֵל" וְגוֹמֵר — **He began "Return, Israel," etc.** תְּלָה בְּדִידְהוּ, — **placing it on them,** וְסִיֵּם עַל זֶה — **and concluded on it "** "כִּי כָשַׁלְתָּ בַּעֲוֹנֶךָ" — **"for you have stumbled in your iniquity,"**

דְּדָרְשִׁינַן מִזֶּה (שָׁם בְּיוֹמָא) — **from which we derive (there in Yoma),** דְּנַעֲשִׂין כִּשְׁגָגוֹת — **that they become like inadvertent sins.** וְהַיְנוּ מִיִּרְאָה — **and that is from fear.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ אָמַר "אֶרְפָּא" וְגוֹמֵר — **And afterward He said "I will heal," etc.**

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8 **Berachos 33b** — free choice, fear, and divine assistance: R' Chanina teaches, "Everything is in the hands of Heaven except the fear of Heaven," deriving it from **Devarim 10:12**. Rashi explains that a person's natural circumstances — long or short life, poverty or wealth, wisdom or foolishness — are decreed, but whether one becomes righteous or wicked is entrusted to the person, before whom two paths are placed. Rambam, *Shemoneh Perakim* ch. 8, similarly limits "everything" to natural conditions and insists that mitzvah and aveirah remain matters of choice. Rashi to **Megillah 25a** adds the important nuance: Hashem can transform the heart, yet the initial preparation of the heart toward fear was handed to man. R' Tzadok develops exactly this progression in *Ohr Zarua LaTzadik, Galus Mitzrayim 4:4-6*: yirah is the arena of human choice and effort; ahavah can then enter the heart "of itself." Human awakening from below is the gate, and afterward "the Holy One helps him." Accordingly, "Return" is phrased as an imperative to man, while "I will heal" is Hashem's answering gift.

9 Zoharic background to fear as "female" and love as "male": **Mishlei 31:30** supplies the phrase "a woman who fears Hashem," while **Kiddushin 2b** states that it is the way of the man to seek the woman. R' Tzadok reads these as a spiritual metaphor. In the kabbalistic map, yirah aligns with restraint, gevurah and the receptive/feminine principle; ahavah aligns with chesed, the right side and the bestowing/masculine principle. Zohar II 216a gives the controlling order: after fear rests upon a person, love — identified there with the right side — is awakened, and through love the worshipper rises and cleaves above. The metaphor therefore describes movement from disciplined receptivity to an overflowing gift; it is not a claim about the relative spiritual worth of men and women. Compare ***Tzidkas HaTzadik §200***: revealed yirah can be awakened through a person's own self-rebuke, whereas revealed "great love" is a gift of Hashem and is not attained by effort in the same way. Together with *Ohr Zarua LaTzadik, Galus Mitzrayim 4:4*, this is the closest parallel to the present se'if: fear is cultivated; love comes afterward from Heaven and completes the return.

שֶׁיִּזְכּוּ מֵעַצְמָן לְאַחַר כָּךְ — **that they will merit of themselves afterward** עַל יְדֵי זֶה לְאַהֲבָה — **through this, to love** וְלָשׁוּב מֵאַהֲבָה — **and to return out of love** עַד דְּיֵרָפֵא — **until it is healed.**

גַּם הַשְׁוּבָבוּת[10] — **even the waywardness.** וְעִקַּר לְשׁוֹן רְפוּאָה — **And the essence of the term "healing",** הֵינוּ כְּשֶׁנִּתְרַפֵּא לְגַמְרֵי — **is when one is healed completely,** דְּאִם הוּא כִּשְׁגָגוֹת — **for if it is like inadvertent sins**

הֲרֵי גַּם הַשּׁוֹגֵג צָרִיךְ — **then even the inadvertent sinner needs** וְכַפָּרָה סְלִיחָה[11] — **forgiveness and atonement,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (בְּנָזִיר כ״ג עַמּוּד ב׳) — **as they said (in Nazir 23b),**

וַעֲדַיִן הוּא צָרִיךְ — **and he still needs.** רְפוּאָה דִּסְלִיחָה — **the healing of forgiveness.** וְעַל כֵּן מִ"אֶרְפָּא" גּוּפֵיהּ — **And therefore from "I will heal" itself,** נַמִּי מְדַיֵּק — **he also infers,**

דְּמִשְׁמַע דְּנִתְרַפֵּא לְגַמְרֵי — **that it implies one is healed completely,** וְאֵין צָרִיךְ עוֹד סְלִיחָה — **and needs no further forgiveness,** וְאִם הוּא מִשְּׁוּבָבוּת וְשִׁטּוּת — **whereas if it is from waywardness and folly** עַל יְדֵי רוּחַ שְׁטוּת — **through a spirit of folly**

דְּיֵצֶר הָרָע — **of the evil inclination** עֲדַיִן נֶחְשָׁב כְּשׁוֹגֵג — **it is still considered as inadvertent,** וְצָרִיךְ עוֹד לִרְפוּאָה — **and still needs healing,** וְ"אֶרְפָּא" מַשְׁמַע — **while "I will heal" implies**

רְפוּאָה שְׁלֵמָה — **complete healing** שֶׁלֹּא צָרִיךְ עוֹד אַחַר כָּךְ — **so that afterward one needs no further.** לִרְפוּאָה שְׁנִיָּה — **second healing.**

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10 **Hoshea 14:2**-5, **Yoma 86b**, and the meforshim: The prophecy begins with Israel's own act — "Return, O Israel, to Hashem your God, for you have stumbled in your iniquity" — and proceeds through confession to Hashem's response, "I will heal their backsliding; I will love them freely." **Yoma 86b** reads "you have stumbled" as a willful sin reduced to a mere stumbling: teshuvah from fear turns *zedonos* into *shegagos*, while teshuvah from love turns them into merits; Rashi states this distinction directly. Radak explains that Hashem first heals the earlier rebellion and then loves Israel after His anger has turned away. Metzudas David notes that removal of enmity does not itself create love, so the renewed love is a divine gift. Malbim likewise reads a progression from healing to positive love. Maharsha to **Yoma 86b** emphasizes the added good generated by the penitent's return. R' Tzadok's sharper reading is that the verse's order maps the penitent's ascent: human yirah first strips the sin of deliberate rebellion, and the divinely granted ahavah then heals and transforms the remaining deed. Compare *Peri Tzadik, Vayeilech and Shabbos Shuvah §§9 and 11*, where he repeats the sequence of human return, heavenly assistance, and the former bad deeds ultimately producing a pleasing fragrance.

11 Nazir 23a (the standard daf checked directly) teaches 'אישה הפרם וה׳ יסלח לה — באשה שהפר לה בעלה והיא לא ידעה ... שהיא צריכה כפרה וסליחה': a wife who knowingly acts against her vow after her husband already annulled it, without knowing of the annulment, still needs forgiveness for her wrongful intention. R. Akiva draws the parallel of someone intending forbidden food but receiving permissible food. Thus intention may require atonement even when the intended forbidden result does not occur; an actual inadvertent act likewise cannot simply be called complete healing. Rav Tzadok's printed citation here appears as Nazir 23b, but the passage is on 23a in the verified text. Preserve the inherited Hebrew citation while recording the corrected daf in the note. **Sources:** Nazir 23a, Mishnah and following baraita; Bamidbar 30:13; Takanas HaShavin 11, Seif 2 (inherited reference: Nazir 23b).

Se’if 3 · סעיף ג

The theme: Teshuvah from fear uproots the evil intention that accompanied the earlier act. The willful sin is therefore reclassified as inadvertent, leaving the deed without its former rebellious will. This is a genuine retroactive uprooting, as expressed in the promise that Israel’s iniquity will be sought and not found (Yirmiyah 50:20).

(ג) וְגַם לְפִי מַה שֶּׁכָּתַבְתִּי לְעֵיל — **And also according to what I wrote above (**רֵישׁ סִימָן א**) — (beginning of section 1),** דִּרְפוּאָה מַשְׁמָע לְהַבָּא — **that “healing” implies going forward,** וְעַד הֵנָּה הָיָה — **and until now it was as it was**

וְלֹא שָׁנְעֲקַר לְמַפְרֵעַ — **and not uprooted retroactively,** עַיֵּין שָׁם — **see there,** יֵשׁ לוֹמַר גַּם כֵּן — **one can say as well** דְּהוּא מְכֻוָּן לְמַה שֶּׁכָּתַבְתִּי — **that it aligns with what I wrote**

דְּקָאֵי אִרְפוּאָה — **that it refers to the healing** דִּתְשׁוּבָה מֵאַהֲבָה — **of repentance out of love.** הַבָּאָה אַחַר הַתְּשׁוּבָה מִיִּרְאָה — **which comes after the repentance out of fear.** דְּעַל יְדֵי הַתְּשׁוּבָה מִיִּרְאָה — **For through repentance out of fear,**

נֶעֱקַר מַחֲשַׁבְתּוֹ הָרָעָה הַקּוֹדֶמֶת — **his earlier evil thought is uprooted,** דְּעַל יְדֵי זֶה נַעֲשָׂה — **for through this are made** מִזְּדוֹנוֹת שְׁגָגוֹת — **from willful sins, inadvertent ones,** שֶׁהוּא מַעֲשֶׂה — **which is an act.**

בְּלֹא כַּוָּנָה וְרָצוֹן לָרַע — **without intent or desire for evil.** וְדָבָר זֶה הוּא עֲקִירָה לְגַמְרֵי — **And this is a complete uprooting** לְמַפְרֵעַ, — **retroactively,** דְּהַמַּחֲשָׁבָה שֶׁהָיָה לָרַע — **for the thought that was for evil**

הוּא כְּמִי שֶׁאֵינָהּ. — **is as though it does not exist.** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר — **And about this it is said “** בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא יְבֻקַּשׁ עֲוֹן יִשְׂרָאֵל וְאֵינֶנּוּ — **“On that day the iniquity of Israel will be sought, and it will not be,** וְחַטֹּאת יְהוּדָה וְלֹא תִמָּצֶאנָה”, — **and the sins of Judah, and they will not be found,”**

דְּעָוֹן דְּהַיְנוּ בְּמֵזִיד — **for “iniquity,” meaning willful,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (יוֹמָא ל״ו עַמּוּד ב׳) — **as they said (Yoma 36b),** אֵינֶנּוּ כְּלָל — **is gone entirely,** כֵּיוָן דְּנֶעֱקַר הָרָצוֹן דְּרַע — **since the desire for evil is uprooted**

לְגַמְרֵי לְמַפְרֵעַ. — **completely, retroactively.** חַטֹּאת” מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן “ — **Not so “sins,”** דְּהוּא שׁוֹגֵג — **which is inadvertent** שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה מִקֹּדֶם מֵהַמֵּזִיד — **made earlier from the willful,**

עַל יְדֵי הַתְּשׁוּבָה מִיִּרְאָה הַקּוֹדֶמֶת — **through the earlier repentance out of fear,** שֶׁהוּא הַשְׁאָרַת הַמַּעֲשֶׂה הַגּוֹלְמִית — **which is the leftover raw deed,** בְּלֹא כַּוָּנָה — **without intent;** זֶה נִתְרַפֵּא אַחַר כָּךְ — **this is healed afterward.**

עַל יְדֵי הַתְּשׁוּבָה מֵאַהֲבָה — **through repentance out of love.** וְלֹא שָׁנְעֲקַר לְמַפְרֵעַ — **And not uprooted retroactively** כְּאִלּוּ לֹא הָיָה מֵעוֹלָם וְאֵינֶנּוּ, — **as if it never was and is gone,** דְּאִם כָּךְ — **for if so,**

מָה נַעֲשָׂה כִּזְכִיּוֹת — **how is it made into merits,** וְעַל כָּרְחָךְ — **and you must say** דְּהַמַּעֲשֶׂה אֵין נֶעֱקָרֶת כְּלָל — **that the deed is not uprooted at all.** רַק נִתְרַפֵּאת — **but healed.**

וְזֶהוּ “דְּלֹא תִמָּצֶאנָה”, — **And this is “they will not be found,”** לֹא דְּאֵינָהּ — **not that it does not exist** רַק דְּנִתְהַפְּכָה לִזְכוּת — **but that it was turned into merit,** וְאֵין הַחַטָּאת נִמְצֵאת — **and the sin is not found,**

שֶׁאִם הַמְקַטְרֵג יְחַפֵּשׂ אַחֲרֶיהָ — **for if the accuser searches for it** לֹא יִמְצָא[12] — **he will not find it.** כֵּיוָן שֶׁנִּשְׁתַּנְּיָת לִזְכוּת[13] — **since it has changed into merit.** וְאָמַר תְּחִלָּה "יִשְׂרָאֵל", — **And He said first "Israel,"**

כִּי תְּשׁוּבָה מִיִּרְאָה — **for repentance out of fear** נִתְעוֹרְרוּ כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל לָזֶה — **all Israel were awakened to** בְּמַעֲשֵׂה דַּעֲגֶל — **in the incident of the calf,** שֶׁלֹּא הָיוּ רְאוּיִים לְאוֹתָהּ מַעֲשֶׂה — **who were not fit for that act**

אֶלָּא לְהוֹרוֹת תְּשׁוּבָה — **but to teach repentance,** (בַּעֲבוֹדָה זָרָה ד׳ סוֹף עַמּוּד ב׳) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ — **as they said (Avodah Zarah 4b, end),** וּתְשׁוּבָתָם הָיְתָה מִיִּרְאָה[14] — **and their repentance was out of fear**

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12 Yirmeyahu 50:20 distinguishes the fate of iniquity from the continued existence of the person: "יבקש את עון ישראל ואיננו ... ואת חטאת יהודה ולא תמצאינה, כי אסלח לאשר אשאיר" — Israel's iniquity will be sought and will not be, and Yehudah's sins will not be found, because Hashem pardons the remnant. Metzudas David says the remaining guilt is cleansed through the hardship of exile and forgiven. Malbim distinguishes "avon," associated here with idolatry and distortion of understanding, from "chatas," the sin of appetite: the former ceases when that inclination is removed, while the latter no longer incurs a charge because of forgiveness. Yoma 36b distinguishes inadvertent chata'os, deliberate avonos, and rebellious pesha'im in the order of vidui; Rambam, Hilchos Teshuvah 1:1, codifies the confession. Rav Tzadok develops a further distinction: "איננו" can express uprooting of sinful will, whereas "לא תמצאינה" can express a past act whose spiritual meaning has changed through teshuvah from love. These are Rav Tzadok's inferences, not direct statements of the verse's commentators. A separate, illuminating parallel is Berachos 10a: Beruriah corrects Rabbi Meir with "יתמו חטאים" — "Let sins cease," not "Let sinners cease" — and asks him to pray for his tormentors' repentance; they repent. Maharsha on Berachos 10a raises the question how prayer for another's teshuvah relates to free choice. Zohar, Balak 15:193–194, explains that one who confesses turns away from the side of impurity and attaches to the outstretched right hand receiving penitents; confession does not fix the person permanently as wicked. Rambam, Hilchos Teshuvah 7:6–7, describes the penitent as beloved and close instead of distant. Thus the person is not identical with the sin, and the historical event need not be denied in order for the accusation to disappear. Compare Tzidkas HaTzadik §100, the related interpretation in Takanas HaShavin 15:77, and the earlier footnote's additional parallel in Peri Tzadik, Shemini §4 (last parallel retained for printed-edition collation). **Sources:** Yirmeyahu 50:20; Metzudas David and Malbim ad loc.; Yoma 36b; Rambam, Hilchos Teshuvah 1:1, 7:6–7; Berachos 10a; Maharsha ad loc.; Tehillim 104:35; Zohar, Balak 15:193–194; Tzidkas HaTzadik 100; Takanas HaShavin 15:77; cf. Peri Tzadik, Shemini 4 (edition collation outstanding).

13 Yoma 86b records two teachings of Reish Lakish. Teshuvah from fear makes "זדונות נעשות לו כשגגות" — deliberate sins become like inadvertent sins; return from love can make "זדונות נעשות לו כזכיות" — deliberate sins become merits. The Gemara reconciles the teachings as "כאן מאהבה, כאן מיראה." Rav Tzadok explains the difference between removing culpable intent and repairing the past at its spiritual root. In Peri Tzadik, Vayeilech and Shabbos Shuvah §9, his wording is "וההבדל בין שוגג למזיד שהמזיד הוא עם מחשבה ורצון וזה נתבטל ע"י הדיבור ונשאר רק המעשה לבד ולכן נעשית לו כשגגות" — "The difference between inadvertent and deliberate sin is that the deliberate act has thought and will; these are nullified through words of return, leaving only the action, which is therefore like inadvertent sin." The higher completion is stated in Tzidkas HaTzadik §100: "ועל ידי זה, אחר התשובה הגמורה, הוא זוכה שזדונות נעשין זכיות" — "Through this, after complete return, he merits that deliberate sins become merits." This is retrospective rectification, not permission to choose sin. Rambam, Hilchos Teshuvah 2:2, still requires abandonment of the sin, remorse, firm resolve not to repeat it, and spoken confession. In Rav Tzadok's application, the fall can become the occasion for deeper longing, humility, and closeness; the act is not retroactively declared permissible. **Sources:** Yoma 86b; Hoshea 14:2; Yechezkel 33:19; Peri Tzadik, Vayeilech and Shabbat Shuvah 9; Tzidkas HaTzadik 100; Rambam, Hilchos Teshuvah 2:2.

14 Avodah Zarah 4b–5a says that the Golden Calf became a communal precedent through which later sinners learn that teshuvah remains open. In the paired teaching, David serves as the example for the individual. The Gemara emphasizes that the nation was not disposed to such a fall in its elevated state, and frames the story as opening the path of return; it does NOT declare idolatry permissible or eliminate human responsibility. Rav Tzadok applies this to the two stages of the Golden Calf's repair: repentance from fear first converts the intentional quality into an inadvertent sin, while the subsequent prayers of Moshe seek the further forgiveness still needed. Peri Tzadik, Vayeilech and Shabbat Shuvah §18 states this distinction explicitly, including the remaining liability conveyed by 'וביום פקדי'. **Sources:** Avodah Zarah 4b–5a; Shemos 32:30–34; Yoma 86a–b; Peri Tzadik, Vayeilech and Shabbat Shuvah 18; Takanas HaShavin 11, Seif 3.

כְּשֶׁהִגִּיד לָהֶם מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם — **when Moses our teacher, peace be upon him, told them.** חֶטְאָם הַגָּדוֹל וְעָנְשָׁם — **their great sin and its punishment.** (שָׁם בְּפָרָשַׁת תִּשָּׂא) וְעַל כֵּן נֶאֱמַר — **And therefore it is said (there, in Parashas Tisa) “** בְּיוֹם פָּקְדִי וּפָקַדְתִּי עֲלֵיהֶם חַטָּאתָם”. — **“On the day of My reckoning, I will reckon upon them their sin.” “.**

חַטָּאת” הַיְנוּ שׁוֹגֵג — **“Chatas” means inadvertent.** לְפִי שֶׁלֹּא נִמְחַל לְגַמְרֵי — **Since it was not forgiven fully** רַק נַעֲשָׂה כְּשׁוֹגֵג — **but made like inadvertent** דְּצָרִיךְ עֲדַיִן סְלִיחָה — **which still requires forgiveness.**

וְעוֹנָשׁ לְכַפָּרָה — **and punishment for atonement.** וּמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם — **And Moses, peace be upon him,** בִּתְפִלָּתוֹ פָּעַל סְלִיחָה — **by his prayer effected forgiveness,** לְאוֹתָהּ שָׁעָה לְגַמְרֵי — **for that hour completely,**

וְעַל זֶה הָיוּ כָּל תְּפִלּוֹתָיו — **and for this were all his prayers** לְסָלְחַ לְגַמְרֵי — **to forgive completely.** שֶׁלֹּא יֵחָשֵׁב גַּם שׁוֹגֵג — **so that even inadvertent not be counted.** דְּגוּף הַמְּחִילָה אַחַר שֶׁשָּׁבוּ — **For the forgiveness itself, after they repented,**

אֵין צָרִיךְ לְהַרְבּוֹת בִּתְפִלָּה — **needs no abundant prayer,** דִּכְבָר יָדוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ פְּתוּחָה — **for His blessed hand is already open** לְקַבֵּל שָׁבִים — **to receive returnees,** וְהַשָּׁב וּמִתְוַדֶּה מוֹחֵל לוֹ. — **and one who returns and confesses is forgiven.**

רַק לִהְיוֹת דַּעֲדַיִן נִשְׁאַר שׁוֹגֵג — **Only because inadvertent sin still remained,** וְעַל כֵּן אָמַר — **therefore he said “,** חֲטָאתֶם חֲטָאָה גְדוֹלָה” וְגוֹמֵר — **“you have sinned a great sin,” etc. “,** בְּעַד חַטַּאתְכֶם” וְגוֹמֵר — **“on behalf of your sin,” etc. “,**

חָטְא הָעָם הַזֶּה חֲטָאָה” וְגוֹמֵר — **“this people has sinned a sin,” etc. “,** תִּשָּׂא חַטָּאתָם” וְגוֹמֵר — **“bear their sin,” etc.** הַכֹּל לְשׁוֹן חֵטְא שׁוֹגֵג — **all the language of inadvertent sin,** דִּכְבָר שָׁבוּ וְנִתְחָרְטוּ בָּזֶה — **for they had already repented and regretted,**

מִיָּד בִּבְיאַת מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם — **immediately upon Moses’s arrival.** וְדָבָר זֶה בְּדִידְהוּ תְּלִיָא — **and this depends on them.** וְהַתְּפִלָּה לְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ — **And the prayer to the Blessed Name** הוּא לְזַכּוֹתָם — **is to merit them**

לִתְשׁוּבָה מֵאַהֲבָה — **to repentance out of love,** שֶׁהוּא בְּסִיּוּעַ מִן הַשָּׁמַיִם — **which is with Heaven’s help,** וְשֶׁיְכֻפַּר לְגַמְרֵי — **and that it be atoned completely,** שֶׁלֹּא יִהְיֶה עוֹד חֵטְא וְשׁוֹגֵג גַּם כֵּן — **so there be no further sin, nor inadvertent either,**

וְעַל זֶה לֹא הֻבְטַח לְגַמְרֵי — **and about this he was not fully promised,** רַק “בְּיוֹם פָּקְדִי” וְגוֹמֵר — **only “on the day of My reckoning,” etc..** דְּעֲדַיִן נִשְׁאַר חֵטְא שׁוֹגֵג שְׁמוּר[15] — **for an inadvertent sin remains reserved.**

15 **Peri Tzadik, Vayeilech and Shabbat Shuvah 18**: וכאשר המזיד מתחרט במחשבתו אחר החטא אז נמחה החטא של המחשבה ונשאר רק המעשה בלבד כשוגג. ועל גוף מעשה העון נצרך לזה הד׳ חילוקי כפרה כמו שאז״ל. וכמו כן מצינו בתוה״ק במעשה העגל שמיד ביקש משה רחמים ויחל משה וגו׳ מפני שידע שמיד הרהרו ישראל בתשובה ולכן פעל וינחם ה׳ על הרעה שנעשה כשגגות. — “When the intentional sinner regrets the sin in his thought, the sin of thought is erased, and only the act remains, like an inadvertent sin. The act of the sin itself requires the four divisions of atonement, as our Sages said. Likewise, in the Torah’s account of the Golden Calf, Moses immediately sought mercy—“Moses pleaded”—because he knew that Israel immediately entertained repentance; he therefore achieved “the Lord relented of the evil,” since it had become like inadvertent sins.” This is the precise parallel for Rav Tzadok’s distinction between immediate acceptance and the still unrectified deed; the following sentence there expressly connects the latter with “on the day I visit.”

Se'if 4 · סעיף ד

The theme: David — "the man who raised up the yoke of teshuvah" (Avodah Zarah 5a) — attained complete rectification. This is malchus, which Yehudah merited by "prevailing over his brothers" in subduing the yetzer to confess after sinning — reckoned greater than Yosef's mastery, who conquered without any sin and gained but one letter of the Divine Name, whereas Yehudah is called entirely by the Name (Sotah 10b). For Yehudah merited that his very sin become a great merit — the emergence of Mashiach's light from that deed.

(ד) אֲבָל דָּוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם — **But King David, peace be upon him,** הֵקִים עֲלֵיהּ שֶׁל תְּשׁוּבָה הַגְּמוּרָה — **raised up the yoke of complete repentance,** לְתַקֵּן לְגַמְרֵי — **to repair completely,** וְזֶהוּ מִדַּת הַמַּלְכוּת — **and this is the attribute of kingship**

שֶׁזָּכָה יְהוּדָה — **that Judah merited,** אֲשֶׁר גָּבַר בְּאֶחָיו — **who prevailed over his brothers** בִּכְבִישַׁת הַיֵּצֶר — **in conquering the inclination.** לְהוֹדוֹת אַחַר הַחֵטְא — **to confess after the sin.**

דְּזֶה נֶחְשָׁב יוֹתֵר — **For this is considered greater,** מִכְּבִישַׁת הַיֵּצֶר דְּיוֹסֵף — **than Joseph's conquering of the inclination,** שֶׁכָּבַשׁ בְּלֹא חֵטְא כְּלָל — **who conquered without any sin** וְנוֹסַף לוֹ רַק אוֹת אֶחָד — **and only one letter was added to him,**

מִשְּׁמוֹ שֶׁל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא — **from the name of the Holy One, Blessed Be He,** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן יְהוּדָה — **unlike Judah,** דְּנִקְרָא כֻּלּוֹ — **who is called entirely** עַל שְׁמוֹ שֶׁל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא — **by the name of the Holy One, Blessed Be He,**

(כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּסוֹטָה י׳ עַמּוּד ב׳). — **as they said (Sotah 10b).** כִּי הוּא זָכָה — **For he merited** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה — **that** חֶטְאוֹ נֶחְשָׁב לִזְכוּת גָּדוֹל[16] — — **his sin would be counted as a great merit —**

בְּרִיאַת אוֹרוֹ שֶׁל מָשִׁיחַ — **the creation of the Messiah's light,** שֶׁיָּצָא מֵאוֹתָהּ מַעֲשֶׂה — **which came out of that act,** דְּאֵין זְכוּת גָּדוֹל מִזֶּה — **for there is no greater merit than this,** וְזֶהוּ גְּבוּרָה יוֹתֵר גְּדוֹלָה — **and this is a greater strength,**

שֶׁיִּהְיֶה גַּם הָרַע עַצְמוֹ — **that even the evil itself.** נֶהְפָּךְ לְטוֹב מְאֹד[17] — **be turned into very good.** וְיוֹסֵף כְּשֶׁנִּקְרָא יְהוֹסֵף — **And Joseph, when he was called Yehosef,** עֲדַיִן חָסֵר לוֹ ה״א אַחֲרוֹנָה — **still lacked the final Hei,**

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16 Expanded source note: **Sotah 10b** and 36b-37a: **Sotah 10b** reads Yehudah's admission, 'She is more righteous than I' (**Bereishis 38:26**), as a public sanctification of Heaven's Name. Yehudah therefore merited that all four letters of the Divine Name appear in Yehudah, with the additional dalet; Yosef, who sanctified the Name privately by resisting Potiphar's wife, received one added letter - the heh of Yehosef (**Tehillim 81:6**), not a yod. **Sotah 36b**-37a gives the parallel formulation at the Sea: Yosef's private sanctification is contrasted with Yehudah's public sanctification through Nachshon's descent. Rashi on **Bereishis 38:26** adds the Midrashic background to mimmeni: a Heavenly voice declared, 'From Me' these hidden events came, because kings were destined to descend from Tamar. R' Tzadok fuses the two sugyos: public confession is itself Kiddush Hashem, and the tribe's leap into the Sea reveals that confession in national action.

17 Avodah Zarah 5a presents David as the model for a lone sinner's path to teshuvah, in contrast to Israel as a community. I Divrei HaYamim 5:2 states that Yehudah prevailed over his brothers and provided the ruler while the firstborn right belonged to Yosef. Sotah 10b and 36b distinguish Yehudah's public confession and sanctification of the Divine Name from Yosef's private sanctification, expressed in their names. Rav Tzadok reads the royal strength of Yehudah as the ability to take responsibility for an actual sin and transform its result through teshuvah from love, as opposed to Yosef's guarding against the sin in the first place. This is Rav Tzadok's development of the verses and sugyos, not a direct quotation of all these implications from a single source. The older note's suggestion of an Ohr HaChammah gloss on Zohar I 206a is retained as an unresolved bibliographic lead, not an attested quotation. **Sources:** Avodah Zarah 4b–5a; I Divrei HaYamim 5:2; Sotah 10b, 36b; Bereishis 38:26; Takanas HaShavin 11, Seif 4; cf. Ohr HaChammah on Zohar I 206a (unverified bibliographic lead).

שֶׁבּוֹ נִבְרָא הָעוֹלָם הַזֶּה — **with which this world was created,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (בְּמָנָחוֹת ק״ט עַמּוּד ב׳, — **as they said (Menachos 29b),** שֶׁשָּׁם הַפֶּתַח פָּתוּחַ לָצֵאת — **for there the opening is open to exit,** לָבֹא לְטַמֵּא דְּפוֹתְחִין לוֹ, — **for one who comes to defile himself, they open for him,**

וְתַלְיָא כַּרְעֵיהּ — **and its leg hangs.** לְבַעַל תְּשׁוּבָה[18] — **for the penitent.** וּכְבִישַׁת הַיֵּצֶר לְגַמְרֵי — **And conquering the inclination completely** וְלִהְיוֹת צַדִּיק גָּמוּר — **and being a perfect tzaddik,**

לֹא כָּל אָדָם זוֹכֶה — **not every person merits,** דְּ"וְאֵין אָדָם צַדִּיק בָּאָרֶץ", — **"and there is no righteous man on earth,",** וּמָה יַּעֲשֶׂה מִי שֶׁעָבַר וְחָטָא — **and what shall one do who has transgressed and sinned,** וְהָרֵי הָעוֹלָם הַזֶּה כֻּלּוֹ — **and this world, entirely,**

לְפִי זֶה מְרֻחָק מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ — **by this account is distant from the Blessed Name** מִצַּד הַחֲטָאִים שֶׁבּוֹ. — **because of the sins in it.** אֲבָל יְהוּדָה גָּבַר לְבָרֵר — **But Judah prevailed to clarify** דְּאֵין עוֹד מִלְבַדּוֹ — **that there is nothing else besides Him**

וְהַכֹּל מֵאֱמִתּוּת רְצוֹנוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ, — **and everything stems from His blessed true will,** כְּשֶׁמִּתְבָּרֵר אַחַר הַתְּשׁוּבָה — **when it becomes clear after repentance** דְּהַחֲטָאִים הֵם זְכֻיּוֹת גְּדוֹלוֹת[19] — **that the sins are great merits** וְעֲשִׂיַּת רְצוֹנוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמוֹ. — **and the doing of His will, blessed be His name.**

וּבָזֶה נִתְמַלֵּא הַשֵּׁם שָׁלֵם שֶׁלֵּם אֶצְלוֹ, — **And by this the Name was filled whole with him,** שֶׁגַּם עִנְיָנֵי הָאַרְצִיִּים וְגַשְׁמִיִּים שֶׁלּוֹ — **for even his earthly and bodily matters** בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה — **in this world** שֶׁנִּרְאִים כְּרִחוּק מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ — **that appear as distance from the Blessed Name.**

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18 The letter hei of this world has an opening below, and its suspended left leg provides another opening for one returning in teshuvah. Menachos 29b states, 'ומאי טעמא תליא כרעיה? דאי הדר בתשובה מעיילי ליה' — Why is its leg suspended? If one returns in repentance, he is brought in. This is the correct location of Rav Tzadok's letter symbolism. The available digital Hebrew witness of Takanas HaShavin 11 reads '(במנחות ק״ט ב)' (109b); the source teaching is verified at 29b. This apparent folio discrepancy must be recorded without claiming a facsimile has been collated. Bereishis Rabbah 85:1 says that while Yehudah's family underwent crisis, Hashem was preparing the light of the Messiah. Pri Tzadik, Bereishis 14 and Shemos 3 expressly connect the emergence of goodness from darkness with teshuvah from love, which transforms deliberate sins into merits. The deed is not characterized as good before repentance: Rav Tzadok describes the subsequent transformation. **Sources:** Menachos 29b; available Takanas HaShavin 11 Hebrew reading '(במנחות ק"ט ב)' (unverified against printed facsimile); Bereishis Rabbah 85:1; Pri Tzadik, Bereishis 14; Pri Tzadik, Shemos 3; Yoma 86b.

19 Machshavos Charutz §7, paragraph 15, explicitly contrasts Yosef's gevurah directed against the forces of the nations and appetite with 'יהודה גבר באחיו': Yehudah's more inward mastery among his own brothers. Peri Tzadik, Pinchas §15 explains the covenantal integrity embodied in Yosef and David's mission to demonstrate teshuvah for the individual. In Siman 11 Rav Tzadok does not minimize Yosef's restraint; he explains why Yehudah's public admission, followed by rectification, supplies a necessary route for someone who has already fallen. This parallel fits after his argument is developed, where the sins can be transformed into merits, rather than being bunched together with the earlier note on the general phrase 'very good'. **Sources:** Machshavot Charutz 7:15; Peri Tzadik, Pinchas 15; I Divrei HaYamim 5:2; Sotah 10b; Avodah Zarah 5a; Takanas HaShavin 11, Seif 4.

אַדְרַבָּא הֵן הֵם תַּכְלִית הַקִּרוּב[20] — **on the contrary, they are the ultimate closeness.** וְהוּא הָיָה הַמַּתְחִיל — **And he was the one who began,** בְּוִדּוּי וְהוֹדָאָה עַל חֵטְא — **with confession and admission of sin,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (בְּסוֹטָה י׳ עַמּוּד ב׳) — **as they said (Sotah 10), "**

"מִי גָּרַם לִרְאוּבֵן שֶׁיּוֹדֶה, יְהוּדָה". — **"Who caused Reuben to confess? Judah."** וְזֶהוּ עִקַּר הַתְּשׁוּבָה[21] — **And this is the essence of repentance:** הַוִּדּוּי דְּבָרִים — **verbal confession,** לְהִתְחָרֵט וְלִכָּלֵם — **to regret and be ashamed**

עַל יְדֵי זֶה מֵעֲוֹנוֹ, — **through this over one's sin,** וְכמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בְּדָוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם — **and as it is said of King David, peace be upon him,** כְּשֶׁאָמַר לְנָתָן "חָטָאתִי לַה׳", — **when he said to Nathan, "I have sinned to the Lord,"** מִיָּד אָמַר לוֹ — **immediately he told him ".**

גַּם ה׳ הֶעֱבִיר חַטָּאתְךָ" וְגוֹמֵר[22] — **"The Lord has also removed your sin," etc.** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁקִּפֵּץ שִׁבְטוֹ שֶׁל יְהוּדָה — **And this is why the tribe of Judah** תְּחִלָּה לַיָּם — **first leaped into the sea,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (שָׁם לז עַמּוּד א). — **as they said (there, 37a).**

כִּי עֹנֶשׁ דְּהַיָּם — **For the sea,** אֲרוֹנוֹ שֶׁל יוֹסֵף רָאָה וַיָּנָס — **saw Joseph's coffin and fled,** הוּא בִּשְׁבִיל קִלְקוּל הַבְּרִית הַטְּבִיעָה בַּמַּיִם — **is for the punishment of drowning in water — for corruption of the covenant,**

כְּדַאֲשְׁכַּחַן בְּדוֹר הַמַּבּוּל — **as we find in the generation of the Flood,** וְכֵן עֹנֶשׁ אֵשֶׁת אִישׁ בְּחֶנֶק — **and so the punishment for adultery with a married woman is strangulation,** וְדִינוֹ לִטְבֹּעַ

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20 Rav Tzadok's 'everything is from His true will' must be read only retrospectively, after sincere teshuvah. Devarim 4:35 declares 'אין עוד מלבדו', while Koheles 7:20 describes human frailty. Rambam, Hilchos Teshuvah 5:1, nevertheless insists that an individual freely chooses good or evil; Divine sovereignty cannot license deliberate sin. Pri Tzadik, Bereishis 14 expressly cautions that one should not infer that Hashem desires the deeds of the wicked: the acts become 'טוב מאד' only when rectified through teshuvah from love. Resisei Layla §9 similarly connects the profound Divine understanding of human deeds with the ultimate transformation of wrongdoing into merit; neither passage permits a person to plan a sin. Rav Tzadok's point here is that the very distance once produced by wrongdoing can, through actual teshuvah, lead to deeper closeness. **Sources:** Devarim 4:35; Koheles 7:20; Rambam, Hilchos Teshuvah 5:1; Pri Tzadik, Bereishis 14; Resisei Layla 9; Yoma 86b. The older invocation of Resisei Layla §52 concerning Bilaam/Shittim was not verified in the cited section and is not retained as source evidence.

21 The act of Yehudah's confession supplies a public pattern of teshuvah later exemplified by David. Avodah Zarah 5a teaches that David's episode shows an individual who sins the path to repentance; Sotah 7b links Reuven's confession to Yehudah's precedent, and Sotah 10b presents Yehudah's public acknowledgment as sanctifying the Divine Name. Likkutei Maamarim, Upon Completion of the Talmud §13 explicitly contrasts Yosef's 'לאכפיא' (restraining evil before acting) with Yehudah's 'לאהפכא' (transforming the bitterness of a prior fall). Tzidkat HaTzadik §254 describes David's particular trial as involving desire and kingship; it should not be quoted as saying that David's 'perpetual incompletion' is the teaching's exact language. Rav Tzadok's developed argument here is not that transgression is desirable, but that responsible confession and complete teshuvah can reveal a kind of public Kiddush Hashem unattainable through mere concealment of the failure. **Sources:** Avodah Zarah 5a; Sotah 7b, 10b; II Shmuel 12:13; Likkutei Maamarim, Upon Completion of the Talmud 13; Tzidkat HaTzadik 254; Takanas HaShavin 11:4.

22 Expanded source note: Vidui, shame, and Kiddush Hashem: **Sotah 7b** says, 'Who caused Reuven to confess? Yehudah,' with parallels at **Bava Kamma 92a** and **Makkos 11b**; **Sotah 10b** adds that Yehudah's public admission sanctified Heaven's Name. **Shmuel II 12:13** records David's 'I have sinned to Hashem' and Nasan's immediate assurance of forgiveness. Rambam, **Hilchos Teshuvah 1:1** and 2:2, defines teshuvah as abandoning the sin, regret, resolve, and verbal confession. **Berachos 12b** deepens R' Tzadok's phrase 'to regret and be ashamed': Rav teaches that one who sins and is ashamed is forgiven, first from **Yechezkel 16:63** and then from Shaul, whose shame over Nov kept him from mentioning the Urim veTumim; 'tomorrow you and your sons will be with me' is read as his restoration among the righteous. Vidui therefore converts concealed failure into open submission: shame shows that the sinner no longer identifies with the act, and public confession can become Kiddush Hashem.

בַּנָּהָר — **and its corresponding heavenly punishment is drowning in the river,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (בְּסַנְהֶדְרִין ל״ז עַמּוּד ב׳) — **as they said (Sanhedrin 37b),**

וְיוֹסֵף דְּלֹא חָטָא כְּלָל — **and Joseph, who did not sin at all,** בָּרַח מִמֶּנּוּ. — **fled from it.** וְיהוּדָה שֶׁחָטָא וְשָׁב — **And Judah, who sinned and repented,** קָפַץ לְתוֹכוֹ — **leaped into it,**

קֹדֶם שֶׁנִּקְרַע וְאַחַר כָּךְ נִקְרַע — **before it split, and afterward it split,** וְהַקְּפִיצָה הָיְתָה — **and the leap was** דְּמְקַבֵּל עַל עַצְמוֹ — **that he accepted upon himself** עֹנֶשׁ שָׁמַיִם — **Heavenly punishment**

אִם הוּא מְחֻיָּב בְּכָךְ.[23] — **if he is liable for it.**

Se’if 5 · סעיף ה

The theme: Teshuvah from love is not from fear of punishment; on the contrary, one accepts the punishment willingly, if such is Hashem’s will. And through this Hashem removes even the inadvertent residue, and the penalty is wholly pardoned. Indeed he merits deliverance, and even malchus (Sotah 37a).

(ה) וְזֶהוּ הַתְּשׁוּבָה מֵאַהֲבָה — **And this is repentance out of love,** שֶׁלֹּא מִיִּרְאַת עֹנֶשׁ, — **not from fear of punishment,** דְּאִדְרַבָּא מְקַבֵּל עָלָיו הָעֹנֶשׁ — **for on the contrary he accepts the punishment upon himself** בְּרָצוֹנוֹ — **willingly**

אִם הוּא רְצוֹן הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ כָּךְ.[24] — **if such is the will of the Blessed Name.** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה מִמֵּילָא — **And through this, of itself,** גַּם הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מַעֲבִיר — **the Blessed Name also removes,** חַטָּאתוֹ הַשׁוֹגֵג גַּם כֵּן — **his inadvertent sin as well,**

וְנִמְחָל הָעֹנֶשׁ לְגַמְרֵי — **and the punishment is entirely forgiven,** וְאַדְרַבָּא זוֹכֶה עַל יְדֵי זֶה — **and on the contrary through this he merits** לִישׁוּעָה וְנֵס — **salvation and a miracle** וְלִינָּצֵל מֵאוֹתוֹ עֹנֶשׁ, — **and to be saved from that punishment,**

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23 Sotah 36b–37a preserves a dispute about which tribe entered the Sea first: R. Meir describes Binyamin, while R. Yehudah describes Nachshon ben Aminadav of Yehudah entering while the other tribes hesitated. The sugya's praise of Yehudah's daring is tied to his subsequent rule. Another Midrashic tradition (Midrash Tehillim on Tehillim 114) says that the Sea saw Yosef's coffin and fled, echoing Yosef's flight from temptation (Bereishis 39:12). Sanhedrin 37b states that one liable to chenek may die by drowning after the cessation of judicial executions; this is the legal analogy employed by Rav Tzadok. Rav Tzadok himself draws the further contrast: Yosef resisted the transgression before it happened, whereas Yehudah, having confessed, willingly entered the water even if punishment was due. Neither the Gemara nor the Midrash explicitly states this entire combined interpretation. The earlier footnote's specific Kli Yakar attribution was not independently located at the claimed Exodus source and is withheld rather than presented as an exact quotation. **Sources:** Sotah 36b–37a; Tehillim 114:3; Midrash Tehillim 114:4; Bereishis 39:12; Sanhedrin 37b; Takanas HaShavin 11:4–5. Kli Yakar cross-reference requires original-section confirmation.

24 Expanded source note: Primary source, halachic framework, and R' Tzadok: **Yoma 86b**:3 resolves two statements of Reish Lakish: teshuvah from fear reduces deliberate sins to inadvertent ones, whereas teshuvah from love transforms them into merits. Sforno on **Shemos 34:7** reads venakeh in this light: complete cleansing belongs to those who return from love, whose sins are accounted as merits. Rambam, **Hilchos Teshuvah 2:2**, defines the formal elements of teshuvah as abandoning the sin, removing it from one's thought, resolving never to repeat it, regretting the past, and verbal confession. R' Tzadok's willing acceptance of punishment is therefore not an additional judicial condition or a call to seek suffering; it describes the inner surrender of love, in which the penitent wants only Hashem's will. **Resisei Layla section 38** explains 'with all your soul' (**Devarim 6:5**) as surrendering even one's spiritual self-interest and consenting to lose the soul itself for the Divine will. That parallel clarifies the se'if: the penitent accepts whatever Hashem wills, and precisely this bitul opens the change from shogeg residue to complete merit.

וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה זָכָה גַּם כֵּן לְמַלְכוּת[25] — **and through this he also merited kingship,** כְּדְאִיתָא (בְּסוֹטָה שָׁם). — **as stated (in Sotah 37a).** כִּי מִדַּת הַמַּלְכוּת — **For the attribute of kingship** הִיא ה׳ אַחֲרוֹנָה דְּשֵׁם[26] — **is the final Hei of the Name,**

כַּנּוֹדָע — **as is known,** כִּי זֶהוּ מִדַּת מַלְכוּתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ — **for this is the attribute of His blessed kingship,** אֲשֶׁר בַּכֹּל מָשָׁלָה[27] — **which rules over all,** גַּם בַּמַּדְרֵגוֹת הַיּוֹתֵר תַּחְתּוֹנִים — **even in the lowest levels**

הַכֹּל הוּא מֵהַנְהָגָתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ — **everything is from His blessed guidance** וְאֵין שׁוּם דָּבָר חוּץ לְמֶמְשַׁלְתּוֹ וְהַנְהָגָתוֹ. — **and nothing at all is outside His dominion and guidance.** וּמַלְכוּת יִשְׂרָאֵל הוּא מַה שֶּׁחָלַק — **And the kingship of Israel is what He apportioned,**

מִכְּבוֹדוֹ לִבְשָׂר וָדָם[28] — **of His glory to flesh and blood,** וְזָכוּ לָהּ עַל יְדֵי הַתְּשׁוּבָה מֵאַהֲבָה — **and they merited it through repentance out of love,** שֶׁנַּעֲשׂוּ גַּם הַזְּדוֹנוֹת כִּזְכִיּוֹת — **in which even the willful sins became like merits** וְנִתְבָּרֵר דְּאֵין שׁוּם דָּבָר **and it became clear that nothing is**

נֶגֶד כְּבוֹד מַלְכוּתוֹ. — **against His glorious kingship.** וְאִדְרַבָּא עַל יְדֵי הַחֵטְא — **And on the contrary, through the sin,** אַחַר שֶׁהוֹדָה בָּזֶה — **after he confessed it,** נִתְקַדֵּשׁ שֵׁם שָׁמַיִם בְּפַרְהֶסְיָא — **the Heavenly Name was sanctified publicly,**

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25 Expanded source note: **Sotah 36b**–37a — Yehudah, the Sea, and kingship: R' Yehudah teaches that the tribes hesitated until Nachshon ben Aminadav and the tribe of Yehudah entered the Sea. Tehillim 69 is read as Nachshon's prayer while the waters reached him, and Hashem then told Moshe, 'Speak to the children of Israel that they travel' (**Shemos 14:15**). The Gemara concludes that for this reason Yehudah merited dominion in Israel, expounding **Tehillim 114:2**–3: 'Yehudah became His sanctuary; Israel His dominion; the sea saw and fled.' R' Tzadok reads the descent as willing acceptance of Heaven's judgment: precisely the submission that does not flee punishment becomes the act through which the decree is removed and malchus is revealed.

26 Expanded source note: Zohar — the final heh as Malchus: Zohar, Tzav 56:1 identifies the yoke of the kingdom of Heaven with the final heh of the Divine Name, which is called Malchus. The standard sefirotic correspondence is yud–Chochmah, first heh–Binah, vav–the six middos, and final heh–Malchus (see Sulam on Zohar, Vayikra 285:1). Malchus receives the higher lights and reveals them below; therefore it is the letter associated with the lowest and most manifest realm. R' Tzadok uses this kabbalistic map as the architecture of teshuvah: the final heh reveals that Divine kingship reaches the very place that appeared most distant, so even a fall can become the site of renewed revelation.

27 Expanded source note: **Tehillim 103:19** and the reach of Malchus: The full verse reads, 'Hashem established His throne in the heavens, and His kingship rules over all.' In peshat, the heavenly throne is followed by universal sovereignty over every part of creation. **Tikkunei Zohar 40b**:2 says that no action among the lower realms occurs except through Malchus, applying this verse; **Tikkunei Zohar 56b**:10 identifies the Shechinah with the same kingship and describes it as ruling even over the realm of the Tree of Knowledge of good and evil. R' Tzadok therefore stresses the lowest levels: evil has no independent sovereignty, though human free choice and responsibility remain fully real. Teshuvah uncovers the deeper rule that was concealed within the apparent opposition.

28 Expanded source note: **Berachos 58a** — earthly kingship as borrowed glory: The Gemara's exact blessing over a Jewish king is 'Who shared of His glory with those who fear Him,' while over a gentile king it is 'Who gave of His glory to flesh and blood.' The same passage teaches, 'earthly kingship is patterned after heavenly kingship,' and urges one to see kings so that the future distinction can be recognized. Shulchan Aruch, **Orach Chaim 224:8**, codifies these blessings. R' Tzadok's phrase compresses the two Talmudic formulas; it is not presented as the verbatim text of the berachah. His point is that human sovereignty is never autonomous: Israel's malchus is a portion of Divine glory entrusted to human beings and is legitimate only insofar as it reveals Heaven's kingship.

וְגָרַם בּוֹ קִדּוּשׁ שֵׁם שָׁמַיִם — **and he caused thereby a sanctification of the Heavenly Name** יוֹתֵר מִמַּה שֶׁפָּעַל יוֹסֵף — **greater than what Joseph achieved.** בְּכָבְשָׁהּ מֵחֵטְא[29] — **by conquering the temptation to sin.** וְזֶהוּ כָּל עִנְיַן הִתְגַּלּוּת כְּבוֹד מַלְכוּתוֹ — **And this is the whole matter of the revelation of the glory of His kingship,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה קִדּוּשׁ שֵׁם שָׁמַיִם בָּעוֹלָם — **that there be sanctification of the Heavenly Name in the world,** וּלְכָךְ נִתְיַחֵס תְּשׁוּבָה מֵאַהֲבָה לִיהוּדָה[30] — **and therefore is ascribed. repentance out of love to Judah.**

וְכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל נִקְרָאִים עַל שֵׁם יְהוּדָה — **And all Israel are called, after Judah,** דְּמִקֶּרֶב אַחֶיךָ תָּקִים עָלֶיךָ מֶלֶךְ" כְּתִיב — **for it is written "from among your brothers you shall set a king over you,"** דְּהַקָּמָתוֹ הוּא מִקֶּרֶב — **for his establishment is from within,**

וּמֵהַפְּנִימִיּוּת שֶׁל כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל — **and from the inwardness of all Israel,** רַק שֶׁאֶצְלָם הוּא בְּהֶעְלֵם — **only that with them it is hidden** וּבְקֶרֶב לִבָּם[31] — **and within their hearts.** וְאֶצְלוֹ הוּא בְּהִתְגַּלּוּת וּבַפֹּעַל — **while with him it is revealed and in action.**

וְעַל יְדֵי הִתְעוֹרְרוּתוֹ — **And through his awakening** נִתְעוֹרֵר גַּם כֵּן תְּשׁוּבָה — **repentance is also awakened,** בְּכָל הַלְּבָבוֹת דִּבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל — **in all the hearts of the children of Israel,** שֶׁגַּם כְּלַל הַכְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל — **for the entire community of Israel too,**

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29 Expanded source note: **Sotah 36b** and 10b — private and public Kiddush Hashem: **Sotah 36b** contrasts Yosef, who sanctified Heaven's Name in private and received one added heh in Yehosef, with Yehudah, who sanctified the Name publicly and contains the entire four-letter Name within Yehudah. The Gemara there identifies the public act with Yehudah's descent into the Sea. **Sotah 10b** supplies the complementary personal model: Yehudah publicly admitted concerning Tamar, 'She is more righteous than I,' and a Heavenly voice affirmed his confession. R' Tzadok joins these two expressions of Yehudah: entering judgment publicly and confessing after failure reveal a greater Kiddush Hashem than hidden mastery alone, because the power of teshuvah itself becomes manifest before others.

30 Expanded source note: Gemara and meforshim on public sanctification and kingship: **Sotah 36b**:10 contrasts Yosef, who sanctified Heaven's Name privately and received one added letter in Yehosef, with Yehudah, who sanctified the Name publicly and bears the entire four-letter Name within Yehudah. Rashi there identifies Yehudah's public act with the descent into the Sea. **Sotah 37a**:6 then concludes that Yehudah merited dominion in Israel, expounding **Tehillim 114:2**, 'Yehudah became His sanctuary; Israel, His dominions.' Maharal, Netivos Olam, Netiv Ahavas Hashem 2:2, explains the contrast as one of spiritual form: Yosef's attachment is hidden, while Yehudah's blessing and Kiddush Hashem are revealed before all. Ben Yehoyada on **Sotah 37a** adds that the leap did not first create Yehudah's royal destiny; it secured the continuity of that kingship. R' Tzadok joins this national act to the personal act of teshuvah: willing entry into judgment becomes public Kiddush Hashem, and the same submission that accepts the decree becomes the source of rescue, miracle, and enduring malchus.

31 Expanded source note: Peshat, halachah, Kabbalah, and R' Tzadok: **Devarim 17:15** commands, 'From among your brethren shall you set a king over yourself.' In its plain halachic use, 'from among' sets a boundary on appointment: Rambam, **Hilchos Melachim 1:4**, applies it to the king and other positions of authority. R' Tzadok then reads mikerev homiletically as 'from the inward core': the king actualizes a royal point hidden within the people. **Berachos 58a**, codified in Shulchan Aruch, **Orach Chaim 224:8**, calls the blessing over a Jewish king 'Who apportioned of His glory to those who fear Him,' while the blessing over a gentile king says 'Who gave of His glory to flesh and blood.' The distinction supports R' Tzadok's point that Israel's kingship participates in Divine glory rather than standing as an autonomous power. The Zohar, Tzav 8:56, identifies the yoke of Heaven's kingship with the final heh; Zohar, Introduction 30:241, identifies Knesses Yisrael with that final heh as it receives and unites the higher powers. **Machshavot Charutz 7:18** supplies R' Tzadok's parallel: every Jewish soul includes both Yosef and Yehudah, but Yehudah is Israel's primary name and the root of Knesses Yisrael because his power repairs deficiency and creates renewal after a fall.

כַּאֲשֶׁר שָׁבִים לְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ בֶּאֱמֶת וּמִתְאַחֲדִים בְּמִדַּת מַלְכוּתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ, — **when they truly return to the Blessed Name and unite in His blessed attribute of kingship,** שֶׁזֶּהוּ הַכְּפִירָה בַּעֲבוֹדָה זָרָה — **which is the denial of idolatry,**

מִבִּלְעָדָיו יִתְבָּרַךְ, שֶׁאֵין שׁוּם כֹּחַ שִׁלִּיטָה וּמֶמְשָׁלָה — **that there is no power of rule or dominion apart from Him, blessed,** וְכָל הַכּוֹפֵר בַּעֲבוֹדָה זָרָה נִקְרָא יְהוּדִי[33] — **and whoever denies idolatry is called a Jew,**

כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בִּמְגִלָּה י״ג רֵישׁ עַמּוּד א׳ — **as they said in Megillah (13a),** שֶׁזֶּהוּ קְדֻשָּׁתוֹ שֶׁל יְהוּדָה — **for this is the holiness of Judah.** שֶׁנִּקְרָא כֻּלּוֹ עַל שֵׁם הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא — **who is called entirely by the Name of the Holy One, Blessed Be He.** וְכֵן כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל — **And so all Israel**

דְּמְסָרֵי נַפְשַׁיְיהוּ — **who give up their lives** עַל קִדּוּשׁ הַשֵּׁם — **for sanctification of the Name,** לְקַדֵּשׁ שֵׁם שָׁמַיִם בְּפַרְהֶסְיָא — **to sanctify the Heavenly Name publicly,** שֶׁלֹּא לְהַשְׁגִּיחַ בְּמֶלֶךְ בָּשָׂר וָדָם — **not to heed a king of flesh and blood**

כַּחֲנַנְיָה מִישָׁאֵל וַעֲזַרְיָה — **like Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah,** דְּנִקְרְאוּ גּוּבְרִין יְהוּדָאִין — **who were called Jewish men.** דְּמִזֶּה יָלְפִינַן לָהּ הָתָם[34] — **from which we derive it there.**

וְעַל כֵּן אָמַר — **And therefore He said ",** וְגוֹמֵר "(וְלֹא תִמָּצֶאנָה) חַטַּאת יְהוּדָה — **“the sins of Judah (and they will not be found),” etc.** דִּבְהִתְגַּלּוּת קְדֻשָּׁה זוֹ — **for in the revelation of this holiness,** הוּא הַסְּלִיחָה גְּמוּרָה — **is the complete forgiveness,**

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32 **Zohar, Introduction 30:241**: פַּרְשְׁתָא רְבִיעָאָה וְהָיָה אִם שָׁמוֹעַ, כְּלִילוּ דִּתְרִין סִטְרִין דְּאִתְאַחֲדַת בְּהוּ כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל גְּבוּרָה דִּלְתַתָּא. וְדָא ה בַּתְרָאָה דְּנָטְלָא לוֹן וְאִתְכְּלִילַת מִנַּיְהוֹן. — “The fourth passage, “And it shall be if you listen,” includes the two sides with which the Congregation of Israel, the lower gevurah, unites. This is the final hei, which receives them and is included from them.” The context is the four passages of tefillin: the preceding passage names “When the Lord brings you,” and this passage calls Shema the third. Rav Tzadok draws on the final-hei identification to explain the king’s awakening of the collective heart.

33 Expanded source note: **Megillah 13a** — why 'Yehudi' means rejection of idolatry: Mordechai belonged to Binyamin, yet Megillas Esther calls him a Yehudi. The Gemara answers that anyone who repudiates idolatry is called a Yehudi, and cites **Daniel 3:12**, where Chananyah, Mishael, and Azaryah are called 'Jewish men' because they refused the royal idol. Maharal, Ohr Chadash 2:5, explains that the name marks exclusive allegiance to the One God against every competing power. R' Tzadok connects this to Yehudah's name, which contains the Divine Name: the holiness of Yehudah is the recognition that no rule exists independently of Hashem. In Yisrael Kedoshim he similarly treats Yehudi as Israel's name of self-surrender and Kiddush Hashem.

34 Expanded source note: Halachah of Kiddush Hashem: **Vayikra 22:32** commands, 'I shall be sanctified among the children of Israel.' Rambam, **Hilchos Yesodei HaTorah 5:1–4**, defines when a Jew must surrender life rather than transgress: the three cardinal prohibitions, specified cases of public coercion before ten Jews, and a time of persecution, with the detailed distinctions set out there. He names Daniel, Chananyah, Mishael, and Azaryah among the scriptural models. Thus mesirus nefesh is governed by halachah and is not a general license to seek danger. R' Tzadok invokes its inner root: the Yehudah-point refuses to acknowledge an earthly power as independent of Divine kingship, and that absolute allegiance is the deepest source of public Kiddush Hashem.

דְּגַם הַשּׁוֹגֵג לֹא נִמְצָא — **for even inadvertent sin is not found.** דְּנַעֲשָׂה זְכִיּוֹת[35] — **because it was made into merits.**

Se'if 6 · סעיף ו

The theme: This is the rule and order for every penitent: even David, in his lifetime, was not shown the complete pardon that turns sins to merits — because teshuvah, on man's side, always begins from fear. Hence "my iniquity I declare, I worry over my sin" (Tehillim 38:19): once he confessed the willful avon, he no longer worried over it. It is surely forgiven — but he still "worried over the chatas [the inadvertent residue] that remains," which needs Hashem's help to return from love.

(ו) וְכֵן הוּא הַמִּדָּה וְהַסֵּדֶר לְעוֹלָם — **And so is the way and order always,** שֶׁל כָּל בַּעֲלֵי תְּשׁוּבָה — **of all penitents,** דְּאַף דָּוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם — **for even King David, peace be upon him,** בְּחַיָּיו לֹא הוֹדִיעֻהוּ — **in his lifetime was not informed**

מִמְּחִילָה הַגְּמוּרָה — **of the complete forgiveness,** לִהְיוֹת כִּזְכִיּוֹת — **that it become like merits,** דְּתְּחִלַּת הַתְּשׁוּבָה — **for the beginning of repentance** שֶׁמִּצַּד הָאָדָם לְעוֹלָם — **from the human side is always.**

מִיִּרְאָה הוּא[36] — **out of fear.** (תְּהִלִּים לח) וְעַל כֵּן אָמַר — **And therefore he said (Psalms 38), "** עֲוֹנִי אַגִּיד אֶדְאַג מֵחַטָּאתִי", — **"I declare my iniquity; I am troubled by my sin,"** וְרֵישֵׁיהּ דִּקְרָא שָׁם — **and the beginning of the verse there, "**

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35 Yirmiyahu 50:20 states that the iniquity of Israel will be sought and absent, and the sins of Yehudah will not be found, 'כי אסלח לאשר אשאיר'. Metzudas David explains that the restored remnant has been forgiven so that a search will uncover no guilt. Malbim distinguishes Israel's 'avon', associated with alien worship and distorted belief, from Yehudah's 'chatas', associated with desire. Rav Tzadok interprets this more deeply: when teshuvah from love is completed, even the inadvertent residue ceases to be found in its previous spiritual form, because wrongdoing has been transformed into merit (Yoma 86b). The preceding notes already explain the separate Megillah 13a teaching that repudiating idolatry earns the designation 'Yehudi' and the halachos of Kiddush Hashem. A complementary original parallel is Yisrael Kedoshim 8:16, which connects Yehudah's root to rejection of idolatry and mesirus nefesh. This is Rav Tzadok's exegetical reading of the promise of forgiveness, not the verse's literal assertion that historical acts never occurred. **Sources:** Yirmiyahu 50:20; Metzudas David and Malbim ad loc.; Yoma 86b; Megillah 13a; Daniel 3:12; Rambam, Hilchos Yesodei HaTorah 5:1–4; Yisrael Kedoshim 8:16.

36 Expanded source note: R' Tzadok's order of teshuvah: **Resisei Layla section 36** distinguishes two sounds of the shofar. The groan born of dread is teshuvah from fear, while the weeping of a child yearning for his father is teshuvah from love; the order is first groaning and afterward crying. This corrects a possible compression of the parallel: yearning is the higher stage of love, not the initial fear. The underlying Talmudic distinction is **Yoma 86b**:3: Reish Lakish teaches that deliberate sins become inadvertent sins through teshuvah from fear, but become merits through teshuvah from love. Thus the se'if's claim that teshuvah 'on man's side' begins with fear describes the ordinary human point of entry, not its final measure. Fear enables confession and removes the status of willful rebellion; the complete reversal into merit requires the Divine assistance that awakens love. **Resisei Layla section 36** further associates the higher teshuvah with a level beyond ordinary time, where the future is repaired at its root. **Takanat HaShavin, Siman 5**, likewise explains that the deepest healing reaches the root beneath the manifested sin. David's lifetime uncertainty therefore serves R' Tzadok's broader architecture: pardon can be real before the penitent is shown the final, eschatological disclosure that the fall itself has been incorporated into merit.

לְצָלְעָ נָכוֹן", — **"I am ready to stumble,"** (בְּסַנְהֶדְרִין קז) נִדְרַשׁ — **is expounded (in Sanhedrin 107a),** אַמַּעֲשֶׂה דְּבַת שֶׁבַע[37] — **regarding the incident of Bathsheba,** וּמִשֶּׁהִגִּיד עֲוֹנוֹ וְהִתְוַדָּה עָלָיו — **and once he declared his iniquity and confessed it,**

לֹא דָאַג עוֹד עָלָיו — **he no longer worried about it,** דְּוַדַּאי נִמְחַל — **for certainly it was forgiven** עַל יְדֵי הִתְשׁוּבָה — **through repentance,** שֶׁלֹּא יֵחָשֵׁב עוֹד לְעָוֹן מִזֶּה — **so that it no longer be counted as a willful sin,**

אֶבָל דְּאָגָתִי מֵהַחֵטְא — **but his worry was about the sin,** שֶׁנִּשְׁאַר עֲדַיִן — **that still remained,** דְּלָזֶה צָרִיךְ עֶזְרַ הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ — **for which he needs the Blessed Name's help.** לָשׁוּב מֵאַהֲבָה — **to return out of love.**

וְכֵן אָמַר (שָׁם נ״א) — **And so he said (there, Psalm 51), "** פִּשָׁעַי אֲנִי אֵדָע — **"my transgressions I know,** וְחַטָּאתִי נֶגְדִּי תָמִיד", — **and my sin is always before me,"** דִּילְפִינַן מִינָּהּ (בְּיוֹמָא פ״ו עַמּוּד ב׳) — **from which we derive (Yoma 86b).**

דְּחוֹזֵר וּמִתְוַדֶּה — **that one confesses again.** וְאַפְּשָׁעִים דְּמֵזִיד — **And regarding "transgressions," which are willful,** אָמַר לְשׁוֹן "אֵדָע", — **he used the language "I know,"** דְּהַוְדּוּי הוּא רַק אִידִיעָה — **for confession is only an awareness,**

שֶׁכְּבָר פָּשַׁע לְשָׁעָבַר — **that he already transgressed in the past,** וְאַף דִּכְבָר נִמְחַל — **and although it was already forgiven,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם לֹא יִשְׁכָּחֶנּוּ — **nevertheless he must not forget it,** וְצָרִיךְ לָדַעַת — **and must know it**

וְלִהְיוֹת נִכְלָם תָּמִיד — **and always be ashamed.** מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ עַל זֶה — **before the Blessed Name over this.** אֲבָל "חַטָּאתִי הוּא נֶגְדִּי", — **But "my sin" is "before me,"** תָּמִיד עוֹמֵד לְנֶגְדִּי מַמָּשׁ, — **always standing literally before me,**

כִּי לֹא נִמְחַל עֲדַיִן כְּלָל — **since it was not yet forgiven at all,** דִּבְחַיָּיו לֹא הוֹדִיעָהוּ עֲדַיִן — **for in his lifetime they had not yet informed him** דְּנֶחְשַׁב לִתְשׁוּבָה מֵאַהֲבָה — **that it counted as repentance out of love.** וְלִהְיוֹת נִמְחַל לְגַמְרֵי — **and was entirely forgiven. (**

וּמַהֲרַשׁ״א בַּחִדּוּשֵׁי אַגָּדוֹת שָׁם — **And the Maharsha in Chiddushei Aggados there,** הִרְגִּישׁ קְצָת בָּזֶה — **sensed something of this,** אֶלָּא שֶׁפֵּירֵשׁ — **except that he explained** דְּמַה דְּחוֹזֵר וּמִתְוַדֶּה — **that the one who confesses again.**

הַיְנוּ עַל הַשּׁוֹגֵג — **means regarding the inadvertent.** וּלְשׁוֹן הַגְּמָרָא מַשְׁמַע — **But the Gemara's wording implies** דְּחוֹזֵר וּמִתְוַדֶּה עַל הָרִאשׁוֹנוֹת — **that he confesses again the first ones** כְּמוֹ עַל אוֹתָן שֶׁשּׁוֹנֶה בְּאִוַּלְתּוֹ, — **like those he repeats in his folly.**

וּלְהַחֲשִׁיבָן עֲבֵרָה דְּמֵזִיד — **and counts them a willful transgression.** וְגַם לְפִי דְּבָרָיו — **And also according to his words** הַשָּׁב מֵאַהֲבָה — **one who returns out of love,** אֵין חוֹזֵר וּמִתְוַדֶּה — **does not confess again.**

וְלֹא חִלְקוּ בָּזֶה — **yet they did not distinguish in this.** וְנִרְאֶה עִקַּר — **And the main view seems** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַבְתִּי — **as I wrote,** דְּלְעוֹלָם חוֹזֵר וּמִתְוַדֶּה — **that one always confesses again**

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37 **Sanhedrin 107a:9**: דָּרַשׁ רָבָא: מַאי דִּכְתִיב ״כִּי אֲנִי לְצֶלַע נָכוֹן וּמַכְאוֹבִי נֶגְדִּי תָמִיד״? רְאוּיָה הָיְתָה בַּת שֶׁבַע בַּת אֱלִיעָם לְדָוִד מִשִּׁשֶׁת יְמֵי בְּרֵאשִׁית, אֶלָּא שֶׁבָּאת עָלָיו בְּמַכְאוֹב. — "Rava expounded: What is the meaning of "For I am ready for stumbling, and my pain is before me always"? Bathsheba daughter of Eliam was destined for David from the six days of Creation, but she came to him through pain." Rav Tzadok's distinction between declaring avon and worrying over remaining chatas is his reading of the nearby Psalm38:19. It is not the wording of Sanhedrin's derashah; Yoma86b supplies the fear/love distinction he applies.